Medical Assistant Program

Understanding the Language of Blood Collection

Why Medical Terminology Matters

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- Clear communication in healthcare settings
- Avoiding critical errors
- Enhancing professionalism and confidence

Knowing the correct terms ensures patient safety, supports accurate lab work, and helps you gain credibility as a professional.

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Structure of Medical Terms

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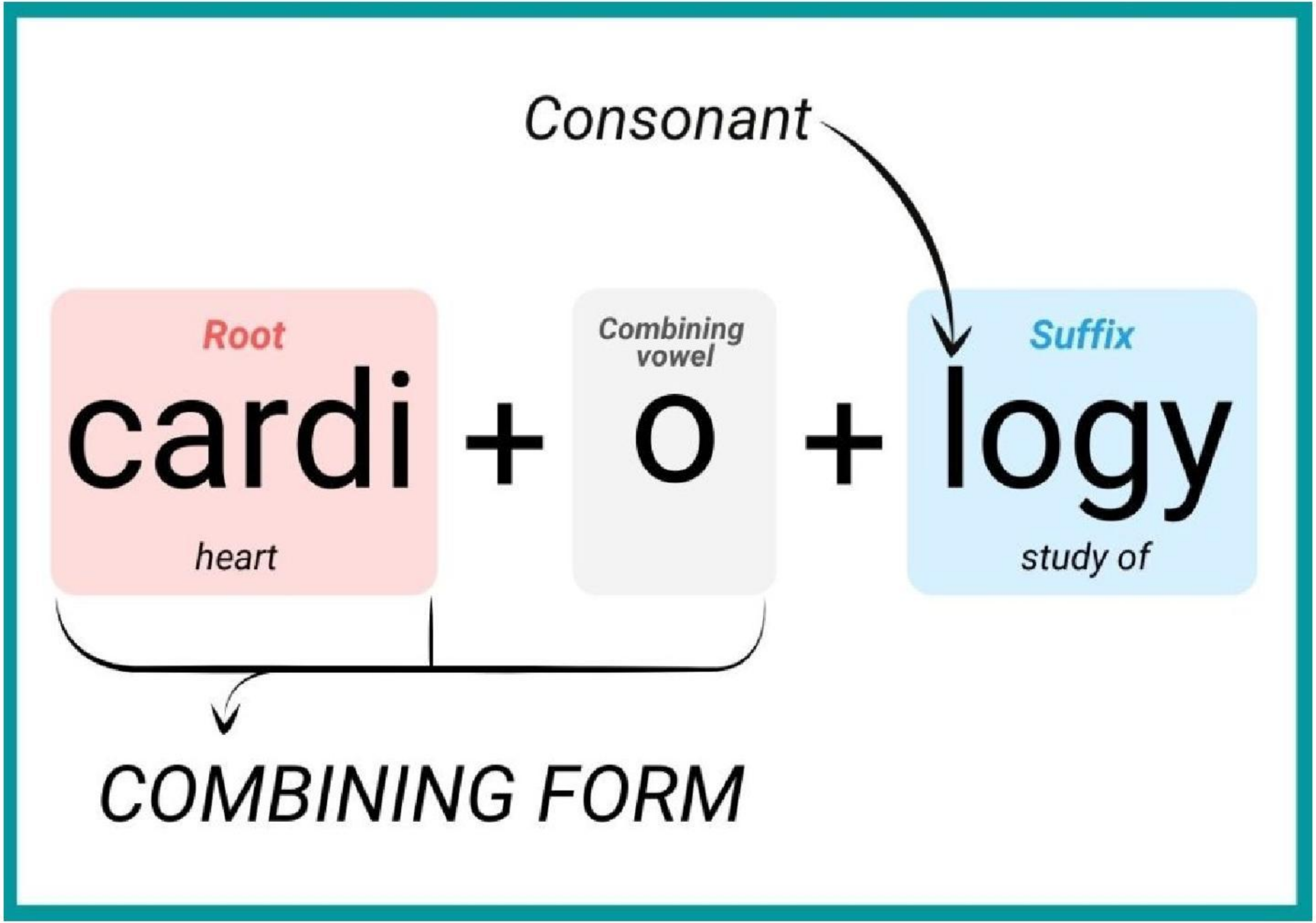
Most medical terms are built from Latin or Greek roots. Understanding how words are constructed helps you decipher unfamiliar terms.

- Prefix + Root + Suffix
- Combining vowels: Usually “o” to join words
- Example: *Venipuncture* = Veni (vein) + puncture (to pierce)


Consonant
Root
cardi
heart
+
Combining vowel
o
+
Suffix
logy
study of
COMBINING FORM

Common Prefixes in Phlebotomy

Common Prefixes in Phlebotomy

Prefix	Meaning	Example
🧪 Hemo-	Blood	Hemolysis
🔻 Hypo-	Below/low	Hypoglycemia
🔺 Hyper-	Above/high	Hyperkalemia
⚔️ Anti-	Against	Antibodies
❌ A-/An-	Without	Anoxia
💓 Tachy-	Fast	Tachycardia
🐢 Brady-	Slow	Bradycardia

Common Roots

Prefix	Meaning	Example
Ven	Vein	Venipuncture
Phleb	Vein	Phlebitis
Hem/o or Hemat/o	Blood	Hematoma
Erythr/o	Red	Erythrocytes
Leuk/o	White	Leukocytes
Thromb/o	Clot	Thrombocytopenia

Common Suffixes

Prefix	Meaning	Example
-otomy	Cutting/Incision	Phlebotomy
-emia	Blood condition	Anemia
-lysis	Breakdown	Hemolysis
-itis	Inflammation	Phlebitis
-gram	Record or picture	Angiogram
-logy	Study of	Hematology

Phlebotomy-Specific Terms

- Capillary Puncture – Blood collection via finger or heel stick
- Tourniquet – Device used to restrict blood flow
- Anticoagulant – Substance that prevents clotting
- Hemolysis – Destruction of red blood cells
- Phlebotomy = Phleb/o (vein) + -tomy (cutting) ⟶ “cutting into a vein”
- Hematoma = Hemat/o (blood) + -oma (mass/swelling)
- Venipuncture = Veni (vein) + puncture (pierce)
- Antecubital = Area in front of the elbow

Lab Terms & Abbreviations

Lab Terms & Abbreviations

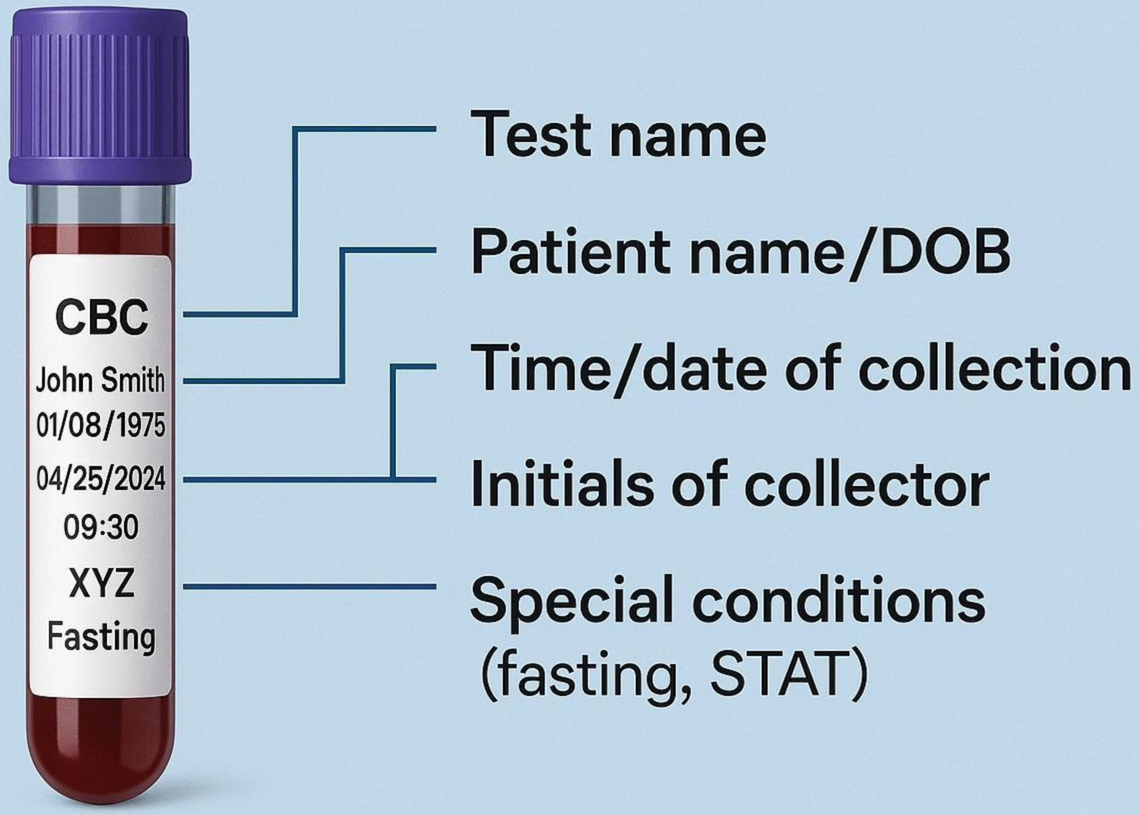
- CBC – Complete Blood Count
- BMP – Basic Metabolic Panel
- PT/INR – Prothrombin Time/Clotting
- STAT – Immediately
- Hgb - Hemoglobin
- Hct - Hematocrit
- ESR - Erythrocyte Sedimentation Rate

Terminology in Tube Labeling

Terminology in Tube Labeling

- Test name (e.g., CBC)
- Patient name/DOB
- Time/date of collection
- Initials of collector
- Special conditions (fasting, STAT)

Terminology in Tube Labeling



Real-World Charting Examples

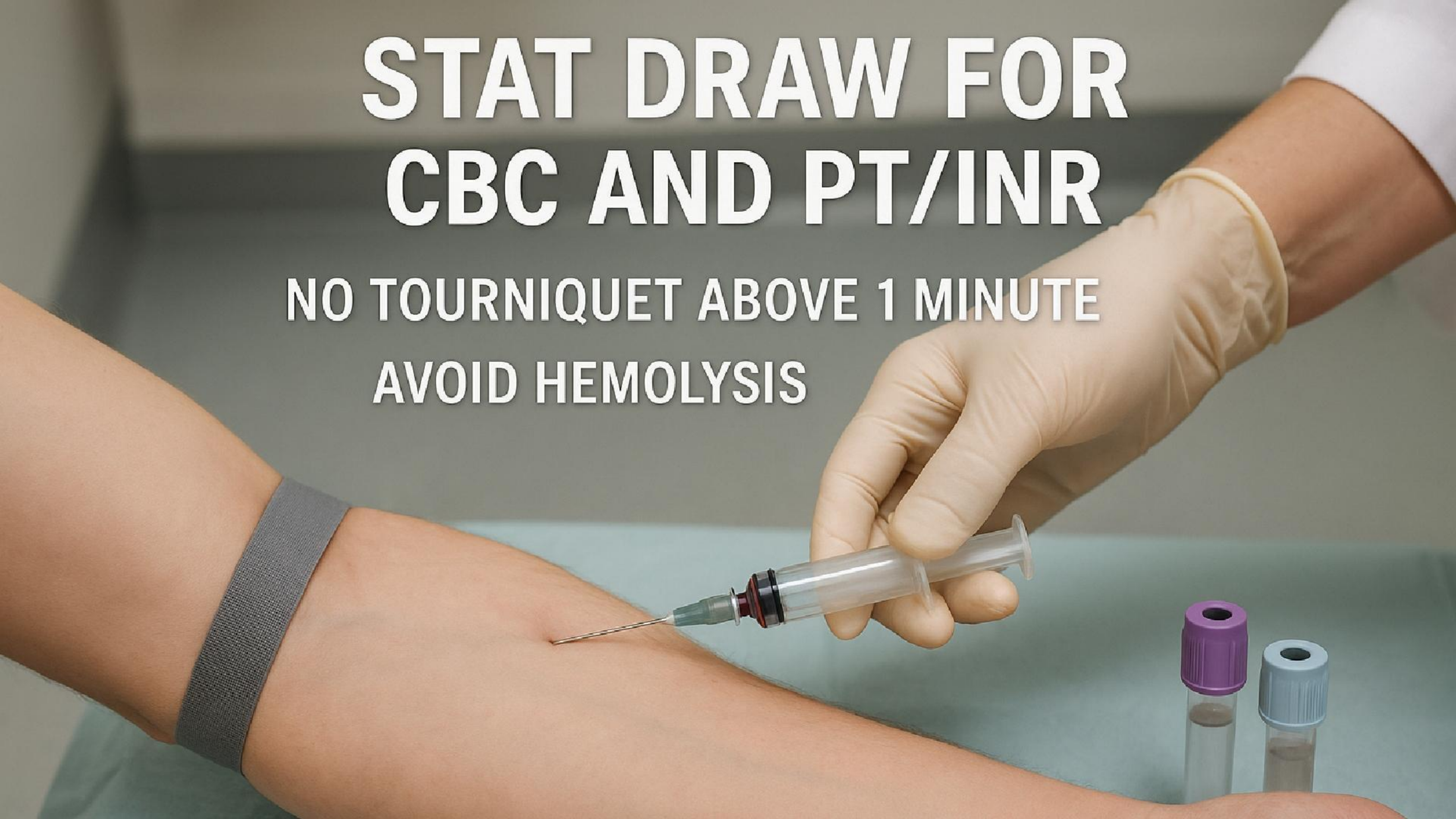
Real-World Charting Examples - STAT Order

Practicing with real-world examples helps you prepare for clinical documentation and interpreting orders correctly.

"STAT draw for CBC and PT/INR. No tourniquet above 1 minute. Avoid hemolysis."

Key Terms to Identify:

- STAT – Immediately, urgent priority
- CBC – Complete Blood Count
- PT/INR – Prothrombin Time / International Normalized Ratio (clotting test)
- Tourniquet – Device restricting venous blood flow
- Hemolysis – Destruction of red blood cells, can interfere with lab results


STAT DRAW FOR
CBC AND PT/INR
NO TOURNIQUET ABOVE 1 MINUTE
AVOID HEMOLYSIS

Real-World Charting Examples - Routine Draw

"Patient requires a fasting lipid panel and CMP. Use butterfly needle for venipuncture. Label tubes immediately."

Key Terms to Identify:

- **Lipid panel** – Blood test measuring cholesterol and triglycerides
- **CMP** – Comprehensive Metabolic Panel
- **Butterfly needle** – A winged infusion set used for difficult veins
- **Venipuncture** – Drawing blood from a vein


Fasting Lipid Panel
CMP

Real-World Charting Examples - Pediatric Patient

“Heel stick for newborn bilirubin test. Use microcollection tube. Protect sample from light.”

Key Terms to Identify:

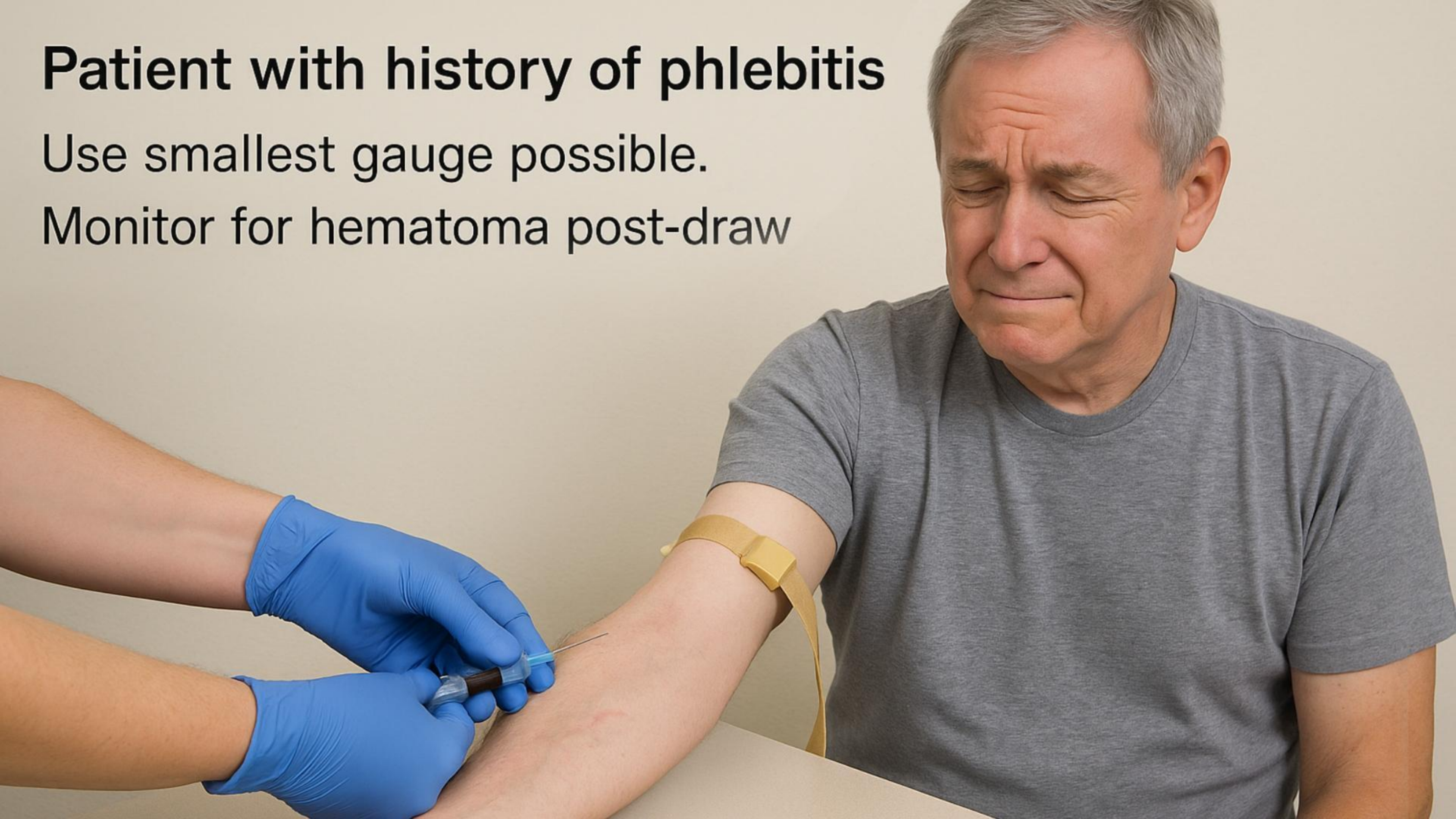
- **Heel stick** – Capillary puncture for infants
- **Bilirubin** – Test to detect jaundice
- **Microcollection tube** – Small tube used for small blood volumes
- **Protect from light** – Bilirubin samples degrade in light

Real-World Charting Examples - Complicated Draw

“Patient with history of phlebitis. Use smallest gauge possible. Monitor for hematoma post-draw.”

Key Terms to Identify:

- **Phlebitis** – Inflammation of the vein
- **Gauge** – Size of the needle; smaller gauge = larger number
- **Hematoma** – Blood pooling under skin, often from vein trauma


Patient with history of phlebitis
Use smallest gauge possible.
Monitor for hematoma post-draw

Real-World Charting Examples - Capillary Collection

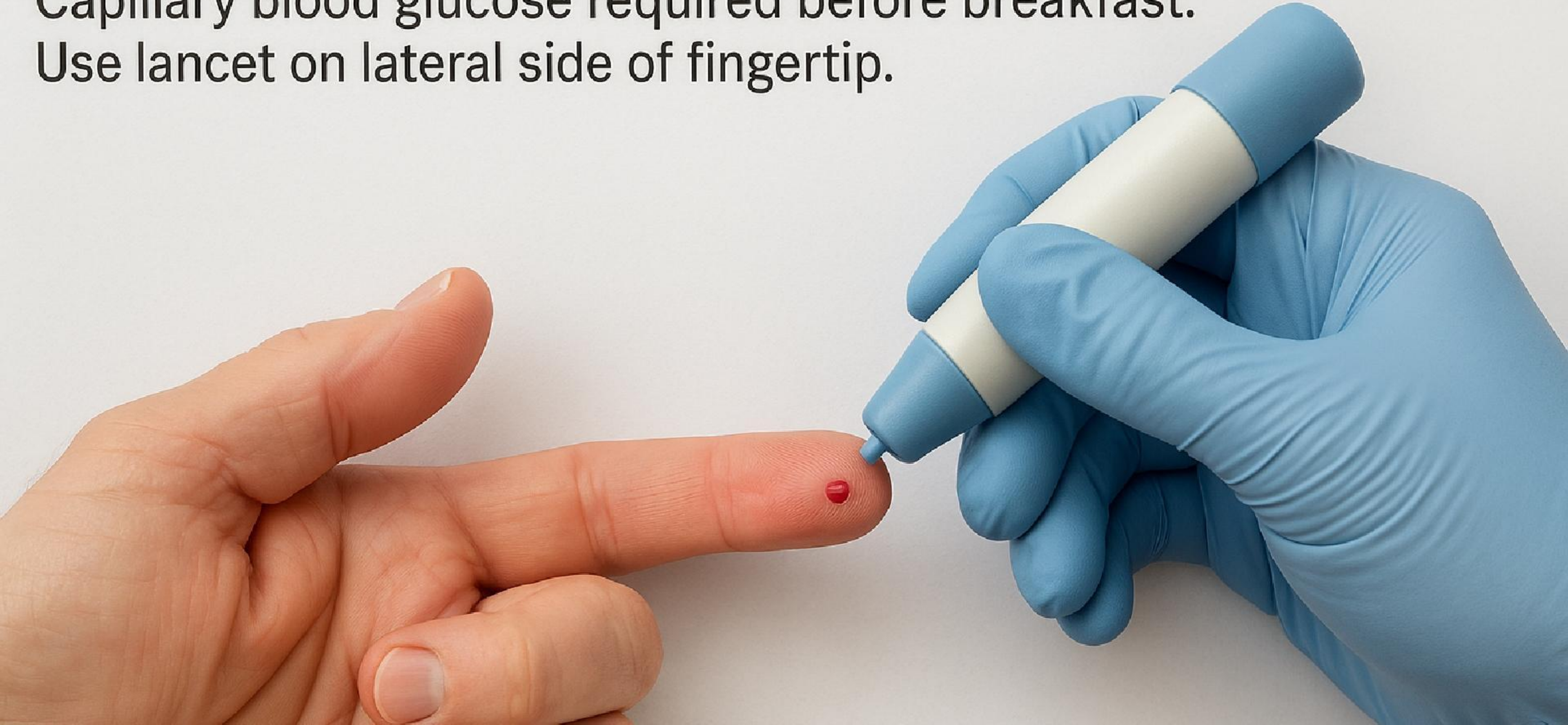
“Capillary blood glucose required before breakfast. Use lancet on lateral side of fingertip.”

Key Terms to Identify:

- **Capillary** – Small blood vessels used for finger/heel sticks
- **Blood glucose** – Test for blood sugar
- **Lancet** – Device for puncturing skin
- **Lateral side** – Outer side of the fingertip, less nerve density

CAPILLARY COLLECTION

Capillary blood glucose required before breakfast.
Use lancet on lateral side of fingertip.



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ASSISTANT SCHOOL